

Tao Xu

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A driven and motivated individual, graduating with the highest distinction from NUFE, and currently studying towards an M.Sc. Development Studies at the University of Edinburgh, with extensive experience gained from completing internships at CITIC, Mazars, Deloitte, and DKU. Possessing exceptional analytical skills, a keen eye for detail, and a proven track record of thriving in pressurised and challenging environments. Diligent and adaptable, with the ability to build and maintain strong working relationships and lead teams as required, committed to continuous personal development, and seeking new professional challenges to apply my knowledge and a highly transferable skill set, from scientific models to the real world, and from praxes back to theories.

SKILLS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

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| ▪ Wicked Problem Solving | ▪ New Structural Economics | ▪ Design and Systems Thinking |
| ▪ Mesoconomics | ▪ Industrial Policy and Strategy | ▪ Inequality & Poverty |
| ▪ Development Studies | ▪ Advanced Manufacturing Cluster | ▪ Regional and Urban Economics |
| ▪ International Economics | ▪ Agglomeration & Spillover | ▪ Epidemiology & Global Health |

QUALIFICATIONS, AWARDS & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

M.Sc. Development Studies (International Development, Expected) - The University of Edinburgh, Nov 2024

Dissertation Topic: The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022

Supervisor: Hazel Gray, PhD, Senior Lecturer in African Studies & International Development

Key Modules: Anthropology of International Development; Politics and Theories of International Development; Research Design & Practice; Resource Politics and Development; Interpreting Development Institutions & Practices; Governance, Development and Poverty in Africa; Key Skills in Development Practice

B.Sc. Economics (Commercial Economics, 1st: 91.29/100) - Nanjing University of Finance and Economics, Jun 2023

Dissertation Topic: Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters

Supervisor: Yabei Hu, PhD, Professor of Industrial Economics

Key Modules: Microeconomics; Macroeconomics; Econometrics; Industrial Economics; International Economics; Regional & Urban Economics; Regional Market and Interregional Trade; Platform Economics; Business Economics; Economics of Business Enterprise; Economic History; Business Design & Innovation; Retailing and Wholesaling Studies; Marketing; Procurement & Supply Chain Management

Summer/Winter Schools, Workshops & Seminars

Political Economy & Economics, Advanced/Grad - Wuhan University, Prof Shaodong Zhou, Jul 2023 - 2024

Economics of AI, Advanced/Grad - University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Prof Yongmiao Hong, Jul 2024

Research Methodology in Applied Economics, Adv/Grad - Nanjing Agricultural University, Prof Zhigang Xu, Aug 2023

Big Data Analytics in Geospatial Sciences, Adv/Grad - Nanjing Normal University, Prof Xueying Zhang, Aug 2023

International Business Management - University of California Los Angeles & University of Saint Joseph (Catholic University of Macao), Prof David E. French, Feb 2022

Training, Courses & Certifications

IELTS Academic C1, College English Test Band 6, National Computer Rank Examination Level 2

Excel & Access & Word & PowerPoint & Publisher & Canva (IT Literate, Communication & Social Media)

Stata & EViews & Python & Matlab & GeoScene (Statistics, Quantitative Economics & Econometrics)

NVivo & VOSviewer & CiteSpace (Text Analytics & Bibliometrics)

Health Systems Development, Epidemiology for Public Health - Imperial College London

Epidemiology: The Basic Science of Public Health - The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
 Microeconomics, The Economics of Health Care Delivery, Comparative Health Systems - University of Pennsylvania
 The Korean Economic Development - Yonsei University, Local Economic Development - Erasmus University Rotterdam
 Understanding Research Methods - SOAS University of London
 Game Theory & Advanced Applications - The University of British Columbia and Stanford University
 New Structural Economics, Behavioural Economics, Introduction to Logic - Peking University
 Corporate Finance, Advanced Quantitative Methods for Social Research - Central University of Finance & Economics

Honours & Awards

Jiangsu Provincial Government Scholarship for Overseas Studies	NUFE Principal's Scholarship
Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award 1st Class	NUFE Honours Graduate
NUFE Distinguished Dissertation Award	NUFE Honours Student *3
NUFE Merit Scholarship for Academic Excellence *6	NUFE Outstanding Student Leader Award
NUFE Merit Scholarship for High Calibre *3	NNU Outstanding Student Award
WHU Outstanding Student Award	WHU Distinguished Paper Award

Professional Memberships

Association for Social Economics (ASE1496)	Chinese Society for Technology Economics (I031402003A)
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PUBLICATIONS

- "Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters," with Yabei Hu, *Technology in Society*, 2024, 102583.
- "Common Prosperity and the Middle Class," *WHU Proceedings of the Summer Institute on Marxian Economics*, 2023, 4, 1–5.
- "Mismatch and Dysfunction in the Ageing Economy: Internet-Optimised Transformation of the Senior Market," with Yukun Gu, Yibo Wang, Yansong Wang, and Qifei Chen, *Journal of the Jiangsu Association for Commercial Economics*, 2021, 38, 3–9.
- "Silver-Hair Industry Reshaped with New Retailing: A SWOT-Based Strategy," *Journal of the China Federation of Logistics*, 2021, 28, 82–85.

WORKING PAPERS

- "The e-CNY as a Cure for SME Financing Obstacles? Based on Modelling and Simulation of Evolutionary Game Dynamics," with Cheng Yuan, and Yansong Wang, 2022, ChinaXiv 202207.00004, National Science Library, Chinese Academy of Sciences, R&R.
- "Entrepreneurs or Employees: What Chinese Citizens Encouraged to Become by Social Attitudes?" 2022, MPRA 113212, University Library of Munich.
- "Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation: 20 Years of Peasant Life in Changing China," with Yansong Wang, and Zhengyi Hu, advised by Dr Yongliang Wu, 2021, arXiv 2204.00785, Cornell Tech.
- "Eudemonia and Freedom: Frontiers and Evolution of Labour and Employment Studies in China," with Weiwei Zhu, advised by Ruru Li and Prof Wenwu Zhang, 2021, MPRA 112908.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Dependency on the State or Balance of Three Pillars? Pension System and Multidimensional Poverty Mitigation in China," with Yansong Wang, Yongfan Li, and Cheng Yuan.
- "Living on the Hump: Multilayered Pension System as a Catalyst for Household Development Resilience," with Yansong Wang.

REPORTS, PRESENTATIONS & BOOK REVIEWS

- "Social Embeddedness of Bolivia's Water Wars: Revisit to Polanyi Critique," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Celebrities as Intermediaries: The Dynamics of Development Communication," 2024, Edinburgh.

- "Good Governance and Political Settlements in Africa," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Turbulence and Order in Economic Development: Economic Transformation in Tanzania and Vietnam by Hazel Gray," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "To Rebel, or Not to Rebel? People First Anthropology in Development Praxis," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Just Transition? Free, Prior, and Informed Consent in Resource-Driven Development," 2023, Edinburgh.
- "Belt of Productivity, Road to Equality: China's Infrastructure Initiative as the 'People First' Development in Indonesia," 2023, Edinburgh.
- "Having People, Having Heart: Charity, Sustainable Development, and Problems of Dependence in Central Uganda by China Scherz," 2023, Edinburgh.
- "The Theory of Economic Development by Joseph Schumpeter," 2022, Nanjing.
- "Survey on Local Pharmaceutical Specialty Stores: Retail Formats, Elements, and Practice," with Y Gu, Y Wang, Dapeng Zhu, Wei Li, Zhenyu Zhang, Jingxia Hou, and Yuhan Yang, advised by Prof Jinguo Tao, 2021, Nanjing.
- "Cultural Industry and Poverty Mitigation: How Industrial Organisations in Less-Developed Areas Capitalise on Local Historical Heritage?" with W Zhu, 2021, Shuzhou.
- "A Study of History by Arnold Toynbee," 2021, Nanjing.
- "Survey on Guannan Rural Areas: Consumption, Social Security, and Manufacturing Industry for the Silver Economy," with Y Gu, and Y Wang, advised by Prof Qifei Chen, 2020, Guannan.
- "Focus on Silver-Hair Group: Ageing Society and Youth Responsibility," with Y Wang, 2020, Guannan.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Coordinator Assistant (Internship) - Duke Kunshan (Kunshan, Suzhou) 2023

Student Affairs, Campus Engagement, Arts & Culture, Clubs & Organisations, FYE & SYE Transition

- Planned and managed training sessions, recruitment applications, policy revisions, registration surveys, evaluation forms, poster-and-flyer designs, check-outs, and general coordination operations to ensure the success of FYSAC, Orientation, and Commencement
- Utilised effective communication skills to support student worker interviews, advised on the development and organisation of student groups including FYSAC (14), OL (107), and Commencement Volunteer (97), selected student leaders, FYSAC chairs and OL captains based on resumes and interview reports
- Attended leadership interviews, presentations, and participated in Student Affairs Learning Series (Becoming Socialised in Student Affairs Administration, NASPA Competency, DEI, and Vowels of Supervision)
- Collected and evaluated event data on program for the spring semester, demonstrated creative writing and infographic design skills to prepare slides and materials for meetings and public account promotions
- Identified characteristics of (un)successful events, and proposed improvements to the evaluation system
- Distributed packages for multiple events, and delivered souvenirs to winners or participants involved in campus programs such as Scavenger Hunt, MOMENT, and De-Stress Festival
- Studied exhibition legal documents, drafted licensing and copyright agreements and contracts for the use of photography works and portraits
- Worked with Clubs & Orgs and FYE as a liaison, compiled info on club leaders for marketing, demonstrated coordination skills to support various events such as Involvement Expo, ACG Expo, Arts & Music Festival, and Guest Speaker Lectures (Google China, UNHCR)
- Worked as the Commencement Committee Assistant, oversaw and improved the content of DKU Yearbook 2023, and translated Chancellors' Remarks for the Commencement Brochure and UG Bulletin
- Sorted multifarious lists for DKU Commencement Registration and Photo Session, coordinated graduation-related tasks such as ceremony, banquet, and concert, and wrote letters, intros, and surveys to announce on DKU Commencement website in English and Chinese
- Assisted with social media, summarised policy-and-procedure docs for the establishment of WeChat official account, arranged (sub-)columns, planned content, structure, and time stage of posting articles and tweets
- Executed administrative and logistical tasks including deposit reimbursement (expense reports), storage management, quarterly reflections, minutes of meetings, and email organisation

Advisor Assistant (Internship) - Deloitte (Industrial Park, Suzhou)	2021
Tax & Business Advisory Services, Transfer Pricing, Operations Transformation	
- Combined business (executive) overviews, prepared tables of investment, fixed assets, tax credits, inventory, contingencies and other key findings - Collated Petroliam Nasional Bhd financial statements and organisation structures of PMCCCL, PLSCCL, PCMC - Assisted in completion of translation and analysis of reports, translated 3 appendices of transfer pricing drafts and supported analysts to search comparable manufacturers and service providers with TP Catalyst - Conducted business reviews with D&B Hoovers to obtain 78 comparable companies for TNMM analysis - Supported the team in using RoyaltyStat database to retrieve 517 CAs, reviewed to obtain 33 potential CAs, and select a total of 8 CAs similar to PMCCCL and PL Italy's business for CUP analysis - Prepared a 42-page report analysing multinational business, intangible assets, and intra-group financing - Analysed real estate and tax incentives for investment promotion in Changzhou and Wuxi, contacted the Bureau of Commerce and International Investment Centre to advise on industrial layout of labour-intensive foreign-owned enterprises in the Shanghai Metropolitan Area - Consulted the State Administration of Foreign Exchange in Xiamen to apply accounting treatment regarding a consortium's internal transformation of capital flow by agreement - Assisted the Suzhou Bureau of Economic and Trade Development in confirming and updating business docs and suggested with tax planning to reduce operation costs and improve compliance	
Audit Assistant (Internship) - Mazars (Industrial Park, Suzhou)	2021
Audit & Assurance, Annual Audit, Reporting & Accounting Operations Advisory Services	
- Audited balance sheets and P&L statements of collective assets and state-owned enterprises in Xiangcheng District, tracked and matched the flow of funds and financial statements, produced 31 draft reports - Verified state-owned assets of Kunshan Hi-Tech Group, independently conducted 7 audit working papers, calculated 9 financial details, reviewed 18 drafts and reported on large transactions	
Consultant Assistant (Internship) - CITIC Securities (Kunshan, Suzhou)	2020
Wealth Management, Investment Consultation, Marketing	
Executive Assistant & Analyst Associate - Global Commerce (Suzhou)	2019 - 2022
Information & Consultation, Certification & Accreditation, FDI, International Trade Administration	
Research Assistant (Internship) - Bureau of Finance (Suzhou)	2019 - 2020
Treasury Management, Fiscal Policy, Government Budget	
Secretary Assistant (Internship) - Administration for Market Regulation (Suzhou)	2018
Quality Supervision, Intellectual Property, Food & Drug Administration, Anti-Monopoly	

PROGRAMMES, COMPETITIONS & CAMPUS EXPERIENCE

- Peer Advisor, the University of Edinburgh School of Political and Social Science & University of Bristol School of Economics, Feminist Microfinance, BRI Narratives, Market Microstructure and Liquidity, *Nov 2023 - Aug 2024*
- Co-Investigator and Research Associate, National Social Science Fund of China Programme, Optimisation of Industrial Ecosystems for Advanced Manufacturing Clusters Based on Producer Services, *Oct 2022 - Jun 2024*
- Peer Advisor, Nanjing University Department of Finance & Insurance and Tsinghua University PBC School of Finance, Monetary Policy and Financial Stability, *Jun - Oct 2023*
- Peer Advisor, Provincial UG Innovative Training Programme, For Rural Revitalisation! Dilemmas and Prospects of Entrepreneurship in Less-Developed Areas, *May 2021 - Oct 2022*
- Investigator and Collaborator, National "Bringing Culture, Science & Health to the Countryside" Programme, How Industrial Organisations in Less-Developed Areas Capitalise on Local Historical Heritage? National Excellent Team Award, Provincial Special Excellent Team Award, NUFE Best Report Award (1st Prize), *Jun 2021 - May 2022*
- Student Assistant, JESIE-UCLA-USJ Cooperation and Exchange Programme, International Business, Leadership, and Management, *Jan - Feb 2022*

- Investigator and Leader, NUFE UG Innovative Training Programme, Silver-Hair Industry Reshaped with New Retailing: A Story of China, *May 2020 - Oct 2021*
- Leader, Chinese Society for Optimisation, Overall Planning & Economic Mathematics Competition, "Mathorcup" MCM, S Award, *Apr - Jul 2021*
- Volunteer, NUFE Admissions Committee, *Dec 2019 - Jun 2021*
- Investigator and Leader, NUFE "Challenge Cup" Academic Competition for UG Students, Digital Economy, New Retailing, and Decent Work: Digital Retailing as a Promoter of Employment? *Nov 2020 - Mar 2021*
- Volunteer and Research Assistant, Jiangsu Administration for Market Regulation Programme, Customer Satisfaction Evaluation and Examination: Tertiary Sector in Jiangsu, *May - Nov 2020*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Language Proficiency: Fluent in English and Mandarin with a good understanding of Wu and Literary Chinese